

EDWARD SPARKS

IT SUPPORT • CYBERSECURITY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Information Technology and Cybersecurity student with hands-on experience in troubleshooting systems, networking fundamentals, and security concepts. Currently pursuing a Bachelor's degree in Cybersecurity while developing practical IT and security skills through independent lab work, technical training, and documented projects. Brings 10+ years of professional technical troubleshooting experience, strong problem-solving ability, reliability in team environments, and a methodical approach to diagnosing and resolving complex problems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

IT Support

Windows 10/11 troubleshooting • Hardware/software troubleshooting • Incident documentation • Customer communication

Windows & Active Directory

Windows Server • Active Directory • Users & groups • Account lockouts • Password policies • Group Policy

Networking

TCP/IP • DNS • DHCP • OSI model • NAT • Virtual networking • Secure protocols

Linux & Virtualization

Linux fundamentals • Ubuntu Server • VMware Workstation Pro • Virtual machines • Virtual networking

Security

SIEM basics • Incident response • Vulnerability scanning • Digital forensics fundamentals • Security monitoring concepts

Tools & Programming

Wireshark • Nmap • TCPdump • Gobuster • SQLMap • Snort • CyberChef • SQL fundamentals • JavaScript basics

HANDS-ON IT & CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS

Help Desk Lab — Built a simulated help desk environment using osTicket, Mailpit, Windows, Active Directory, Ubuntu Server, Docker, and VMware. Documented troubleshooting scenarios involving domain account lockout and Windows workstation performance issues.

Active Directory Lab — Built and administered a Windows Active Directory environment including users, groups, password policies, account lockouts, Group Policy, DNS fundamentals, and domain-joined Windows clients.

Linux & Container Services — Deploying and managing Linux-based virtual machines and containerized services using Ubuntu Server, Docker, and Docker Compose; practicing Linux administration, service configuration, and troubleshooting.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Diesel Mechanic — Rumpke Waste Management | May 2015 – Sept 2019 | Nov 2024 – Present

- Perform preventative fleet maintenance and complex mechanical repairs including brakes, hydraulics, and electrical systems.
- Diagnose system failures using systematic troubleshooting methods.
- Apply safety and quality standards while working in fast-paced operational environments.

Diesel Mechanic — Coastal Waste and Recycling | Nov 2023 – Nov 2024

- Conducted vehicle inspections and preventative maintenance.
- Provided customer service and communicated technical findings clearly to customers and team members.

Lube Technician — Jiffy Lube | July 2023 – Nov 2023

- Performed automotive maintenance services including oil changes and inspections.
- Maintained customer service standards and worked efficiently within a team environment.

Concrete Laborer — KOI Precast Inc. | April 2022 – June 2023

- Built precast concrete forms and operated overhead cranes for concrete pouring and finishing.
- Worked in a coordinated production team to meet strict deadlines and safety standards.

Diesel Mechanic — Best Way Disposal | Sept 2019 – Jan 2022

- Completed preventative fleet maintenance and repair diagnostics.
- Utilized electrical troubleshooting and welding to resolve mechanical issues.

CYBERSECURITY TRAINING

Independent cybersecurity training through TryHackMe covering Linux and Windows fundamentals, networking concepts and core protocols, DNS/HTTP, Active Directory basics, packet analysis, Nmap and network enumeration, web application security fundamentals, SQL fundamentals, OWASP Top 10, cryptography, SIEM/SOC fundamentals, incident response and digital forensics basics, IDS/IPS and firewall fundamentals, MITRE ATT&CK, and penetration testing fundamentals.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science — Cybersecurity — Western Governors University | Currently Enrolled

Associate of Science — Information Technology — University of the Cumberland | 2022 – 2023

Portfolio: sparksseclab.github.io

CAREER FOCUS

IT Support / Help Desk → SOC → Digital Forensics & Incident Response (DFIR)